Chapel Hill Friends Meeting

Newsletter: Eleventh Month, 2026



Monthly Query: *How do I look at the world around me and find hope… and find joy?*

Monthly Worship Tip from the M&W Committee: *Come to Meeting with neither a resolve to speak, nor a determination not to speak, but rather with an attitude of expectant waiting and openness.*

Contents

Monthly Calendar
Upcoming Zoom Fora
Upcoming Events
- Meeting for Worship with Attention to Peace, Thursdays, 7:30pm
- Dance Meditations at Durham Friends, Oct 31 and Nov 14 and 28
- New Adult Education Offering: Quakerism in Everyday Life, Nov. 5, Nov. 19
- Help the IFC Committee "Stuff our Trunks", Nov. 8 and 15
- Friendsgiving, Thurs. Nov. 26
- Piedmont Friends Events for November

Announcements
- Alamance Orange Prison Ministry Pecan Sale. order by Nov. 2
- October 2026 Quaker House Update for Meetings
- Monthly Newsletter of Carolina Friends School
- Vote NO on Constitutional Amendments

Personals
- Home for Sale

Recurring Announcements
- InterFaith Council Committee Is Seeking Volunteers
- Zoom Tech Hosts Wanted
- Inter-Faith Council Pantry Needs Donated Food Items
- FRIENDS, PLEASE LIMIT YOUR WEEKDAY MEETINGHOUSE VISITS.
- Newsletter & eNews Reminder

Recurring Events
- Prayers for Healing/Holding in the Light, 2nd and 4th Wednesday, 7-8:30 pm
- Meeting for Worship with Attention to Peace, Thursdays, 7:30pm
- Pendle Hill Worship via Zoom, Daily, 8:30-9:10am
- Pray for Peace - From Friends House Moscow, Daily

Business Meeting Minutes
- Appendix A: Shotts Memorial and Leadership Development Committee Description
- Appendix B: Monthly Silent Vigils For Love As Action
- Appendix C: Finance Committee Annual Report
- Appendix D: Draft letter to Governor Cooper



Monthly Calendar

First Sunday	• 8:15 - 9:15 am - **Early worship in the meeting room** • 9:30 - 10:30 am - **Forum via Zoom** • 11:00 am - 12:00 - **Worship in the meeting room** • 11:00 am - 12:00 - **Online worship via Zoom** • After meeting - **Potluck in the schoolhouse**
Second Sunday	• 8:15 - 9:15 am - **Early worship in the meeting room** • 9:30 - 10:30 am - **Forum via Zoom** • 11:00 am - 12:00 - **Blended Meeting in the meeting room and via Zoom**
Third Sunday	• 8:00 - 9:00 am - **Early worship in the meeting room** (reverts to 8:15 the following week) • 9:00 - 10:30 am - **Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business via Zoom** • 11:00 am - 12:00 - **Worship in the meeting room** • 11:00 am - 12:00 - **Online worship via Zoom**
Fourth Sunday	• Same as Second Sunday - **Blended Meeting**
Fifth Sunday	• Same as First Sunday, but without potluck



Upcoming Zoom Fora

https://www.chapelhillfriends.org/forums.html

November 1: All Souls Day: Remembering Friends who have passed, and worship sharing on the people in our lives we want to remember at this time.

November 8: Spiritual State of the Meeting, sponsored by Ministry and Worship

November 15: Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business - No forum

November 22: Gratitude and Alternative Gift Mart, sponsored by CYRE

November 29: TBA



Upcoming Events

Meeting for Worship with Attention to Peace, Thursdays, 7:30pm

Every Thursday at 7:30, AFSC's Quaker Engagement team hosts Meeting for Worship virtually for Friends from across the globe. Embracing the practice of Quaker unprogrammed worship, we gather to bring our attention to witnessing injustice in our world and bolstering our solidarity with people facing oppression. Join us to explore and experience the spiritual dimensions of activism and social justice. Sign up here.

Dance Meditations at Durham Friends, Oct 31 and Nov 14 and 28

Jack Wolf of Eno Friends shares with Friends:

We are continuing with our Dance Meditations at Durham Friends Meeting on various Saturdays 4-6 PM in the Fellowship Room.

If you get this in time our next dance will be Saturday Oct. 3 and I will be doing the set. Richard Jerram of Eno Meeting will do a set on All Hallows Oct. 31. Future dances are Nov. 14 and 28th.

We are encouraged by a steady turnout and a smattering of Friends from Durham, CH, and Eno Meetings. Part of our mission is to get Quakers quaking, and I think of the dance as similar to silent worship but with your body in motion to music.

For those new to this type of dance I will paste a description below. One thing to emphasize is that it requires no knowledge of steps or technique and no level of exertion required as we have chairs out and one can just wiggle a finger.

We do not charge but do accept donations just to cover our rent at DFM which is very reasonable and DFM has been very hospitable and Andrew very helpful. It is appreciated.

We ask for folks to arrive by 4 PM and we circle up at 4:10 and dance for 90 minutes to 5:45 and then have a closing circle and socialize until six.

Schedule will be:
4:00 Gather
4:10 Circle Up
4:15 Dance
5:45 Final Circle
5:50 Socialize
6:00 Close Up.

LOCATION,PARKING- The meeting house building is behind the playground and small parking lot. There is a parking lot shared between Durham Friends and the Ronald McDonald House on Alexander. Park in the spots reserved for DFM. Also the lot labelled Duke Police across the street can be parked in on the left side which is not used by the police and there is some parking on the Street
For those new to this form of dance:
Our dances are 90 minutes of improvisational unstructured dance to recorded music designed to create a deep free experience. There is no particular step or skill needed, just a chance to move the body and free the mind. People should abstain from conversation during the dance. Chairs will be there and one need not exert beyond your level of comfort and ability. People dance solo but might also couple up or in groups as they choose.
These types of dances occur internationally and were largely inspired by the late Gabrielle Roth and her 5 Rhythms concept (https://www.5rhythms.com/), though it will be up to the designer of each set and the dancers how strictly they wish to adhere to 5 Rhythms concepts. It can be a useful model. For those interested in 5 Rhythms, Richard Jerram, who is part of our crew, has been teaching this for two decades in the UK and US and is a great resource if you want to learn more about this.

New Adult Education Offering: Quakerism in Everyday Life, Nov. 5, Nov. 19

Kate White shares with Friends:

Kate White of ARE is hosting an evening exploration of Quaker practices, and how we can live them in every day life. We had a forum that explored testimonies and we shared our favorite other practices such as following a leading, messages beyond words, love, gratitude, listening, embodied faith, and more. Kate is hosting three Thursday evenings as an experiment: **October 22, November 5 and November 19**. Meet in the library at 7 pm. Ends at 8:30. Format is check in, discussion of Quaker Practices, workshop sharing about these practices in every day life. Leave fortified! Contact Kate at katercst@gmail.com or call 434-996-2002.

Help the IFC Committee "Stuff our Trunks", Nov. 8 and 15

Please help the IFC Committee "Stuff our Trunks" on Nov. 8 and 15. Trunks will be open before and after Meeting for your gifts to help "Stuff the Holiday Market" at the Interfaith Council. Nonperishable food (not expired!) like mac-and-cheese, baking mixes, canned sweet potatoes and pumpkin and cold weather items like thick, twin-size blankets, sleeping bags, adult gloves and rain ponchos are helpful. Check the complete wish lists at https://www.ifcweb.org/current-needs/. Thanks for celebrating with giving!

John Bell will bring a cooler with ice if you want to provide a turkey or ham (to be delivered on the following Monday morning).

Friendsgiving, Thurs. Nov. 26

Please join us for a Quaker Friendsgiving on Thanksgiving Day. We will meet in the schoolhouse and enjoy a potluck dinner with warm and meaningful friendship.

Please reach out to Tori Toles to receive a sign-up sheet, and more details. torimcclarantoles@gmail.com.

Piedmont Friends Events for November

https://www.piedmontfriends.org/piedmont-friends-monthly-events/

Announcements

Alamance Orange Prison Ministry Pecan Sale. order by Nov. 2





Sally Fisher shares with Friends:

Hello Chapel Hill Friends,
It is pecan time! Alamance Orange Prison Ministry's annual fundraiser has begun- we are selling fresh NC pecans as well as greeting cards that feature beautiful art created by men incarcerated at Orange Correctional Center, a state prison for men in Hillsborough. The shelled pecan halves are very fresh, delicious and grown in North Carolina.They come in one pound bags and are $16 a bag. Both items make great gifts!

The Alamance Orange Prison Ministry (AOPM) has been an important part of our Meeting's "bundle" of concerns for many years. Our meeting is blessed by the men who are incarcerated at Orange Correctional Center (OCC) who are sometimes able to visit us to worship and share a meal. AOPM is the non-profit organization that exists to provide spiritual comfort to the men incarcerated at OCC , most importantly by funding our full time chaplain, Dewey Williams. (If not privately funded, OCC would have no chaplain.)

There are a few ways to order:

1. You can order by credit card directly from the AOPM website:
https://aoprisonministry.org/support-aopm/pecans/
If you would like me to pick up your order on Saturday, November 21st and bring to the Sunday, November 22nd meeting, please note that your order will be "picked up by Sally Fisher." In

checkout- there is a link called "Additional Information," click on that and write "Sally Fisher" and I will bring your pecans/cards to meeting on Sunday, November 22nd.

2. You can order by check using this order form. If you would like me to pick up your order on Saturday, November 21st and bring to the Sunday meeting, please make a note on the order form that your order will be "picked up by Sally Fisher".

3. You can order directly from the AOPM website and pick them up yourself at on Saturday, November 21st at the fellowship hall of Hillsborough United Methodist Church, at 130 W. Tryon Street in Hillsborough, from 9am to noon.

Thank you, Sally Fisher

October 2026 Quaker House Update for Meetings

Curt Torell shares with FriendsÑ

Quaker House continues to let its Light shine in Fayetteville, across the state, and across the country. Executive Director Wayne travels anywhere he is invited to spread the good word, so bring him to your Meeting this winter! GI Rights Counselors Steve and Lenore continue to take calls from service members across the country seeking advice and options, including how to file for conscientious objection. In September 2026, 310 calls came into the hotline, continuing a trend of near record calls this year.

One call that came in this week was from a recent Navy recruit, who was not getting the job speciality advertised to him by a military recruiter. When asked why he joined the Navy, he said it was because the job market is so difficult and he needed the money. He said that he has an Associate's degree, and he can't find work. "Even people with Bachelors degrees, they can't find work." His call was an example of the sobering reality of the "economic draft," which has always been an issue but has been exacerbated by the current administration's horrendous cuts to social services and the public sector and its lethal military policies that are driving up energy and consumer prices worldwide.

Quaker House in the media:

- GI Rights Counselor Lenore was recently quoted in an article in the Nation publication about the crisis of conscience of members of the military.
- In addition, the hotline counselors were very involved in a documentary called Under the Uniform by an Italian filmmaker. Watch the 52 minute film here and share it with Friends! (Note that the link requires a simple registration - the page is in Italian, but the film is in English). It addresses the Christian nationalist influence on the US military, the trans-ban, and conscientious objection and will yield lots of good discussion.

Reconnaissance Substack: Check out the semi-regular posts, including recent ones dealing with Pete Hegseth, on the Quaker House substack! (https://substack.com/@quakerhouse)

Keep your eyes peeled and check back soon for the revamped Quaker House website.

And please consider making a donation to support the excellent and important work of Quaker House. It truly makes a difference.

Questions about Quaker House? Talk to your Meeting representatives Lori Khamala, Rufus King, or Curt Torell.

Monthly Newsletter of Carolina Friends School

Ida Trisolini, Staff Clerk of CFS shares with Friends:

Dear Eno Friends, Durham Friends, and Chapel Hill Friends,

I thought you all would enjoy seeing the newsletter that I send to staff at CFS. Its primary audience is staff, so they can see each others' work, but I always think the Meetings would enjoy seeing how Quaker life is lived at our sweet little school.

This is the message I just sent out to all staff of the school (it is possible that not all the links will be live for you. Some are set for just a CFS email address. I hope you enjoy the rest!)

Dear Friends,

What makes CFS a Friends school?
How does our approach to education center Quaker belief and practice?
How do we teach our children the tenets at the center of our school philosophy?

It is an attempt to share your beautiful answers to this question that prompted me to begin this monthly newsletter celebrating the many ways you all teach our children that they really can "change the world".

Please enjoy this month's edition, which features:

- Our tenet of the month: The Truth is Continually Revealed
- an article about Durham Early School using research questions with children
- "Meet the Mod Squad" - The Mod Squad reflects on Truth
- a TON of resources for exploring t(T)ruth

Celebrating Quaker Belief and Practice in Action at CFS

Monthly Digest, October, 2026

If you are interested in previous editions, here they are:
August 2026
September 2026

Vote NO on Constitutional Amendments

Carolyn White shares with Friends:

At the end of the 2026 ballot, you will have a chance to vote on 3 amendments to the NC Constitution. These amendments are not needed and are in fact detrimental to residents of NC. Instead of saving money for taxpayers, these amendments will force county and local governments to find other funding sources, such as fees and sales tax, for services such as education, healthcare and emergency services. Already, Chapel Hill Public Library is proposing a $65 fee for patrons living outside Chapel Hill. Vote NO on the Constitutional Amendments and spread the word!

- LWVNC handout
- Public Schools First NC handout



Personals

Home for Sale

Allie Scales shares with Friends:

My much loved home in the Kirkwood community is for sale. Two bed, three bathrooms, and lots of bonuses, not least, glorious sunsets, and neighbor to Matt and Lynn Drake! Easy reach of CHFM, and lots of neighborhood amenities.

https://www.zillow.com/homedetails/104-Homewood-Dr-Chapel-Hill-NC-27514/50051796_zpid/



Recurring Announcements

InterFaith Council Committee Is Seeking Volunteers

We invite anyone interested in becoming, or knowing more about being an IFC Committee Member to please contact Tori Toles.

We welcome volunteers to help with food preparation and service at ICF every second Thursday for lunch: 10a - 1p, and/or every second Friday for dinner 4p-6:30p. Volunteers are welcome for part of the shift, or the full shift.

Zoom Tech Hosts Wanted

Support Chapel Hill Friends Meeting's Zoom worship and forums by becoming a tech host. The role is much more simple than you would imagine. Trust us! We need your help and will train you. Please contact the Zoom Subcommittee if interested, or have questions: zoom@chapelhillfriends.org.

Inter-Faith Council Pantry Needs Donated Food Items

Please consider IFC's needs when doing your shopping. There is a basket in the meetinghouse foyer for food donations. IFC has requested the following food items: coffee, hot chocolate, canned protein, canned pork and beans, canned soup (not vegetable), boxed cereal, cake mixes, instant foods, ramen noodles. Thank you!

FRIENDS, PLEASE LIMIT YOUR WEEKDAY MEETINGHOUSE VISITS.

The CFS Early School teachers, parents and guests have priority use of the meetinghouse parking lot from 7:30 AM to 6:00 PM Monday through Friday throughout the calendar year. If you must visit the meetinghouse during weekday hours, please alert John Hite, the Meetinghouse Resident, at least one day ahead. Email: johnthequaker@gmail.com or call: 919-929-5377.

Newsletter & eNews Reminder

Please send items for the weekly eNews email and the monthly print Newsletter to news@chapelhillfriends.org.

- The deadline for weekly eNews is *Wednesday* 5 pm.
- The deadline for the monthly print Newsletter is on the *last day of the month*.

To unsubscribe, email to news@chapelhillfriends.org with the subject line, Unsubscribe.

Note: If you think that you haven't received your weekly enews or monthly newsletter, it helps to add news@chapelhillfriends.org to your contacts. Otherwise it might go to your Spam folder (and likewise for other chapelhillfriends.org mailing lists such as pfym@chapelhillfriends.org).



Recurring Events

Prayers for Healing/Holding in the Light, 2nd and 4th Wednesday, 7-8:30 pm

YOU ARE INVITED TO PARTICIPATE IN Virtual Prayers for Healing/Holding in the Light on the 2nd and 4th Wednesday of each month, 7:00 to 8:30 PM. Join us when you can for as long as you wish - from your own home.

Do you have a name or a group of people to add to - or remove from - the list of those we will hold in our hearts and prayers? If so, please send to: prayers@chapelhillfriends.org. The list of names to be held in the Light will be renewed each month. Names must be resubmitted each month to be maintained on the list. We'll send an updated list on Wednesday afternoons. Thank you for joining us!

This virtual prayer service continues under the care of the Care and Counsel Committee and each week, a committee member will collect and post the names that are submitted and will read them aloud during the time of the service.

Meeting for Worship with Attention to Peace, Thursdays, 7:30pm

Every Thursday at 7:30, AFSC's Quaker Engagement team hosts Meeting for Worship virtually for Friends from across the globe. Embracing the practice of Quaker unprogrammed worship, we gather to bring our attention to witnessing injustice in our world and bolstering our solidarity with people facing oppression. Join us to explore and experience the spiritual dimensions of activism and social justice. Sign up here.

Pendle Hill Worship via Zoom, Daily, 8:30-9:10am

Pendle Hill Quaker Study, Retreat, and Conference Center is now opening their daily morning worship to everyone, by way of Zoom or phone. A lovely opportunity for gathered worship every morning. “A handful of Pendle Hill residents continue to gather daily in the Barn – from 8:30am to 9:10am Eastern Time – expanding the 90-year-long tradition of daily worship here on campus. Beginning the week of March 16, 2020, we started an experiment of opening the circle of worship to YOU in your home. You can join us here via Zoom.”

https://pendlehill.org/explore/worship/join-us-online-for-worship-in-the-barn/?bblinkid=210290749&bbemailid=19903873&bbejrid=1408822779

Note: The above link takes you *not* to the meeting but to a page of general instructions. Look for the sentence "You can join us via Zoom **here**, or by clicking on the image below."

Pray for Peace - From Friends House Moscow, Daily

Link to the Daily Meeting for Worship for Peace sponsored by FHM/FHMSA: (Friends House Moscow)
Join Zoom Meeting
https://us02web.zoom.us/j/4165005614?pwd=NUtieEtqbDBYbjBrcGdMMzBKQ3drQT09
Meeting ID: 416 500 5614
Passcode: 182805

The room opens at 8:45am Pacific time (10:45 EST); worship begins on the hour and ends an hour later. After worship there will be time to share brief thoughts that did not rise to the level of ministry. You may also want to rename yourself indicating your geographic location. There will be no audible indicator when one enters or leaves, and everyone will be muted on entry. Please leave yourself muted unless giving ministry.

Ministry may also be shared in the chat, but it is not the place for private conversations. If you are new to Quaker unprogrammed worship and wish to talk with someone about it, send a message to the host and someone can join you in a breakout room.



Business Meeting Minutes

Chapel Hill Friends Meeting - Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business
Minutes for October 18, 2026, online via Zoom

Jeff Brown, Jennifer Leeman, Tori Toles, Quaker Harmon, Betsy Brinson, Allie Scales, Lynn and Matt Drake, Carolyn White, Tony Hickey, Lydia Kiefer, Melissa Ruof, Jan Hutton, Barry MacKichan, Lloyd Kramer, Julia Cleaver, Hank Elkins, Carolyn Stuart, Colleen Fey, Alice Carlton, Susan Newcomer, Walter Hjelt Sullivan, Tom Ludlow, Marion Schoenbach, Tom Munk, Dottie Heninger, Hart Pillow, Buzz Borchardt, Paul Munk, Susan Peterson, Susan Inglis, Dave Curtin

1. We opened with worship and the query, “How do I face my differences with others and reaffirm in action and attitude my love for those with whom I am in conflict?”

2. The minutes of the September 2026 Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business were approved with the following corrections. A page missing from the appendix reporting on the budget is now included. The last names omitted from the announcement about the Love as Action Vigils are Lydia Kiefer and Carol Rice.

3. A welcoming committee was established for newly transferred members: Melissa Ruof and Lynda and Barry MacKichan. Members of that committee include Julia Cleaver, Carolyn White, and Tori Toles.

4. Lloyd Kramer, on behalf of the Ministry & Worship Committee, presented a recommendation for membership for Taylor Schmidt. The membership committee met two times and included Deborah Gibbs, Traci Hjelt Sullivan, Alice Carlton and Melissa Ruof. A member of that committee reported that the meetings were deeply moving, and all on the committee feel blessed that he is joining our meeting. A welcoming committee was established, including Jennifer Leeman, Walter Hvelt Sullivan, Alice Carlton, and Carolyn Stuart.

5. Jan Hutton presented a new version of the Shotts Memorial and Leadership Development Committee description (Appendix A), revised based on feedback at the last Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business. Friends approved the revised version following one final revision to clarify who can make requests. The revised version is in the appendix.

6. Tom Ludlow, Clerk of the Peace & Justice Committee, presented a proposal to hold monthly silent vigils for Love as Action (Appendix B). Further details on timing and other logistics will be provided in future emails and the newsletter. We currently plan to alternate weekends and weekdays. The next vigil is proposed for November 1st after potluck. Friends approved the proposal.

7. The Clerk proposed two Friends to serve as members of the Naming Committee, with the role of appointing new members to the Nominations Committee. Friends approved the Clerk's naming of Carolyn White and Leslie Rountree.

8. Julia Cleaver, Finance Committee co-clerk, presented the Finance Committee Annual Report (Appendix C). Friends accepted the report with gratitude.

9. The clerk asked if Friends had additional items to present for further seasoning. The concerns raised are as follows:

9a. A Friend reported that Taylor Schmidt has been put in charge of a voting site in Durham. The Friend expressed appreciation for his work and the work of others in our Meeting who are involved in the midterm election.

9b. Julia Cleaver is hoping to get momentum to make our entry way more welcoming and reflective of our care for the environment. Any others who are interested in working on a proposal to bring to Buildings and Grounds, please let Julia know.

9c. Tom Munk reported that Peace Action is planning a rally in front of Roy Cooper's office on October 20th at 8 a.m. He and others on the Peace Action Board have drafted a letter, which he read (Appendix D). A concern was raised about reference to the Democratic Party in the letter. Another Friend clarified that we are supporting an aspect of a platform of the Democratic Party and not the Party itself. Friends approved the letter with Matt Drake standing aside with concern about approving something without adequate seasoning and for the request to support part of the platform of a political party. He also voiced recognition of Friends' concern for peace. John Hite also stepped aside, sharing Matt's concern.

10. The next Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business is planned for 9:00 AM on November 15, 2026.

11. We closed with worship.

Jeff Brown, Clerk, and Jennifer Leeman, Recording Clerk

Appendix A: Shotts Memorial and Leadership Development Committee Description

The Shotts Memorial and Leadership Development Committee is composed of two funding sources. The Shotts Memorial Fund (1973) is an endowment from the Shotts family, supporting opportunities for education, training, and service for members and attenders of the Meeting. The Leadership Development Funds (1982) support standing committees in support of programming that furthers the spiritual and leadership development of the meeting.

These funds are **non-need based.** Grants are awarded through discernment of applications by members appointed to this committee. Both funds are tapped to fill requests.

Members and attenders of the Meeting are strongly encouraged to consider applying for funding support from the Shotts Memorial/ Leadership Development Committee. These are YOUR funds. Friends are welcome to talk with committee members ahead of time to explore the viability of their request.

Your application should include:

- The amount you are requesting;
- Do you have the ability to contribute toward this amount, and if so, how much (not a necessity);
- Information about the program for which you are applying, including any available websites;
- How this funding helps you or the meeting community grow as leaders, Quakers, and good human beings;
- Making the request at least 2 weeks prior to the time of its need

If you are interested in applying for support from these funds, email the Committee at: **shotts-leadershipfunds@chapelhillfriends.org**

Appendix B: Monthly Silent Vigils For Love As Action

American Friends Service Committee (AFSC) has recently launched Love As Action Vigils: a practice of gathering in silent worship to bear witness to concerns for justice and peace and to ground ourselves in love and action. The Peace and Justice Committee supports this initiative and proposes that CHFM host monthly Love As Action Vigils *under the guidelines of the AFSC.*

The vigils are one hour each month and structured as silent worship. They are open to the CHFM community, while welcoming others who wish to join. Participants are able to sign up online in advance. Lydia Kiefer and Carol Rice will serve as coordinators, helping to organize the monthly vigils, manage online sign-ups, and communicate with participants.

Appendix C: Finance Committee Annual Report

July 1, 2025 - June 30, 2026

Introduction

The Finance Committee has responsibility for stewardship of the financial resources of Chapel Hill Friends Meeting, which allows the Meeting to continue its work. The goals of the Finance Committee are to support this stewardship by:

a. Maintaining a balanced budget;

b. Supporting the work of vital committees and providing support for designated Quaker organizations and other local entities approved by Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business (benevolences);

c. Providing and monitoring the level of savings for routine and unanticipated repairs for our facilities and flexibility to cover contingencies; and

d. Maintaining sufficient assets and savings to meet future needs.

The Treasurer provides oversight of the financial health of the Meeting. Working closely with our Accountant, the Treasurer maintains records of the financial transactions of the Meeting, and provides quarterly and annual reports to the Meeting for Worship and Attention to Business. While the roles of the Treasurer and the Finance Committee have been defined separately, we have in practice worked collaboratively. The Treasurer serves as an *ex officio* member of the Finance Committee.

Activities of the Finance Committee in 2025-26

Our activities included:

- Fundraising, collection of donations, and paying of Meeting obligations;
- Reviewing the accounting of income and expenditures, the Meeting's bank and investment accounts, and the financial reserves for use in case of emergencies.
- Managing the Meeting's financial investments, including purchase of one CD in February, 2026, for $35,000 using excess cash in the checking account.
- Preparation of the Meeting's Annual Budget beginning in Spring of 2026. As part of this process, committees provided requests for funding of their planned activities for the upcoming fiscal year. Benevolence requests were also submitted

by relevant committees. As usual, the budget was reviewed by MWAB in May and approved in June.

Following a year of several significant transitions in 2023-24, in 2025-26 we successfully completed our 3rd full year with our Treasurer, Monteze Snyder, and with our Accountant, Peggy James, CPA, and our 2nd full year with Fifth Third Bank, with GuideOne Insurance, and with Servant Keeper's online donation system. The Committee is pleased to report that everything is working smoothly.

The Treasurer reported to the Finance Committee monthly on income and expenses and worked with the Committee in the preparation of the 2025-26 fiscal year report, the quarterly reports to the Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business, and the budget for the 2026-27 fiscal year. The Treasurer kept on-going records to assist in our task. We use Quick Books Online to track our finances, and we log all contributions through Servant Keeper.

We owe a very special thanks to Monteze Snyder, who stepped down as Treasurer on June 30 of this year. Her devoted, honorable and time intensive work made a valuable and lasting contribution to our Meeting. We especially appreciate the extra effort she made to document the processes of the work of the treasurer for her replacement. In addition, she trained our new treasurer, Ann Miller.

Commentary on FY2025-26 Financial Results

In this section, we lead up to our conclusion that the Financial Health of Chapel Hill Friends is good.

As we learned from the Treasurer's report, the Meeting's total revenue of $114,464, including contributions of $104,199, enabled (after subtracting our operating expenses) a positive net operating income of $35,227 for FY2025-26. We are grateful for the generosity of our donors in the Meeting and for the energy and marketing skills of our crew of football and soccer parking volunteers for raising $10,265, well above their budget of $7,200.

On the operating expenditure side, actual spending of only $79,237 compared to budgeted spending of $89,486 was in large part due to the usual underspending by our committees, and to savings resulting from our continued reliance on unpaid volunteer zoom operators.

The Statement of Financial Position document provides a snapshot of all the Meeting's assets and liabilities on a given day, thus permitting comparisons of overall fiscal health of the Meeting from one year to the next. Our total financial assets as of June 30, 2026

were $435,032. That is a healthy 15% increase over the $377,750 in these assets as of June 30, 2025.

A substantial component of this increase in the Meeting's financial assets was due to growth of our Friends Fiduciary (FFC) investment funds, which as of June 30, 2026, accounted for 45% of our total financial assets. We thus focus below on these investments. (FFC is an investment non-profit founded by Quakers in 1898. It offers "socially responsible investment management consistent with Quaker values.")

Table 1 provides details for the three FFC investment accounts held by our Meeting, each of which were 100% invested in FFC's "Growth and Income Fund" a diversified stock and bond fund. Overall growth in our three FFC accounts combined was a robust 23%. Each of our accounts increased substantially in value, largely driven by a 16% increase in the FFC's Growth and Income Fund in which they are invested.

Table 1

Changes in Value of the CHFM's FFC Investment Funds during FY2025-26

CHFM Funds	**30-Jun-25**	**30-Jun-26**	**% change**
Shotts Endowment	44,221	49,719	12%
General Fund Designated	72,410	95,071	31%
Physical Plant Reserve Fund	43,748	52,243	19%
Totals	**160,379**	**197,033**	**23%**

Note that the percentage growth of all three funds differs from the underlying 16% growth in the FFC's underlying Growth and Income Fund. On the positive side, a $10,000 lump sum was invested in the General Designated Fund from our net operating surplus in 2024-25. Another $5,000 from the surplus was invested in the Physical Plant Reserve Account, but $3,763 was withdrawn to pay for plumbing repairs. The under 16% growth in the Shotts Endowment resulted because all dividends are paid out to the Meeting's Shotts account every six months. This leads to a slower growth over time in the Shotts Endowment principal. All dividends are reinvested in the General Fund and in the Physical Plant Reserve Fund, which allows them to grow faster than Shotts.

As for the 16% rate of return in the FFC's Growth and Income Fund, we are pleased with that even though the S&P 500 index rose by an unusually high 21% over the same period. First, about 25% of the Growth and Income Fund is invested in bonds, whose value was virtually flat over the period. Second, and probably most important, investment returns for "Environmental, Social, and Governance" (ESG) stocks and bonds (which broadly represent much of the FFC's investment guidelines) tend to be somewhat lower than for the broader market. Finally, we note that the Finance Committee is considering investing in the newer FFC Green Impact Fund in the future.

We further note that the Meeting has a policy objective, as it has had in the past, of maintaining adequate cash balances in its checking account to cover 2 months of its expenses, and enough in its savings account to cover one year of its obligations. These requirements were met during the FY2025-26 period. We currently have adequate funds in these accounts to meet the substantially higher "obligations" category of our budget in FY2026-27.

Financial Health of CHFM

Overall, the Finance Committee considers that the Meeting's financial health is **good**, and that our financial positions are sufficient to address our obligations and the leadings of the Meeting in FY2026-27.

First, the 15% increase in our total financial assets over the 2025-26 fiscal year continues a trend over the last several years toward increased financial security for our Meeting.

We received sufficient contributions, as well as above-budget parking income, to more than balance our budget this fiscal year, ending with a net operating surplus of $35,227. Of this amount $24,977 is our income surplus .We also note that we received contributions relatively early in the 2025-26 fiscal year, permitting us to fully fund benevolences by the end of March. Again, we are very grateful for the many individuals and families, and for our volunteer parking crew, who made these satisfying outcomes possible.

The Finance Committee has determined that this year's income surplus of $24,977 will be allocated in this way:

- 5,000 to the Care and Council Fund
- 2,000 to the Shotts Leadership Fund
- 5,000 to the FFC Physical Plant Reserve Fund

- 10,000 FFC General Fund Designated
- and retain the rest in reserve in our checking/savings account at Fifth/Third Bank

The 2025-26 members of the Finance Committee were: Julia Cleaver (Co-clerk), Lynda MacKichan, Wendy Michener, Tom Ludlow, Susan Newcomer, Mansir Petrie, (Recording Clerk) Monteze Snyder (Treasurer and *ex officio* member), and David Waterman (Co-clerk).

Appendix D: Draft letter to Governor Cooper

Hello, Governor Cooper,

We thank you for your strong service as our governor, and are following your campaign messages with great interest. We believe one step in your stated goal of improving the economy is to stop the spending of our tax dollars on wars in the Middle East.

As part of a coalition of peace voters, we are bringing these specific asks to you the morning of October 20:

- **Pledge to oppose any defense appropriation or authorization spending that fails to end the war against Iran.** This unauthorized war has killed schoolchildren and American service members, destroyed civilian neighborhoods and water treatment centers, and caused energy prices to skyrocket, wreaking havoc both for everyday Americans struggling to pay for gas and basic goods, and for people living in poverty around the world. If the President won't listen to Congress when it directs him to stop this war, then Congress needs to use its power of the purse to cut off the funds.

- **Release a statement affirming the legally binding nature of the Iran War Powers Resolutions and support future war powers resolutions.** The founders of our country assigned the constitutional power to launch war to Congress, not leaving it up to one person. The House and Senate have both passed resolutions directing President Trump to terminate unauthorized hostilities against Iran. Members of Congress should use their position to enforce.

- Publicly call for and support a peace agreement, which will require lifting sanctions and unfreezing assets. Economic relief is a necessary component of securing verifiable nuclear concessions and long-term de-escalation. Everyday civilians bear the brunt of U.S. sanctions and freezing of public assets, with significant impacts on access to food, medicine, and basic economic stability. Congress should avoid measures that deepen this humanitarian harm or undermine diplomatic progress.

- **Express your full support for the NC Democratic Party's platform regarding Israel, Palestine, Gaza, and Middle East Peace. "**The conflict in Israel and Palestine, including violence in Gaza and settler violence in the West Bank, has caused immense suffering for Israeli and Palestinian people. Democrats have deep commitments to human rights, international law, democratic participation, peaceful resolution of conflicts, and the protection of civilians.

We recognize the suffering endured by civilians in Gaza, Israel, and the broader region. We recognize the humanity of both Palestinian and Israeli people, and we oppose rhetoric that leads to violence. We also recognize that anti-Jewish, anti-Muslim,

anti-Arab, and anti-Palestinian hatred and violence have no place in the Democratic Party or in American civic life.

Consistent with the positions passed by the North Carolina Democratic Party State Executive Committee, we support an immediate embargo on military aid, weapons shipments, and military logistical support to Israel, and we support maintaining that embargo until Amnesty International, Human Rights Watch, and B'Tselem certify that Israel is no longer engaged in apartheid rule."

We invite you to address the crowd and make these statements. We invite you to meet with the leaders of our movement before the 20th, or at 9:30 after the rally.

Joe Cicero, NC Peace Action, for the following organizations
Asheville Jewish Voice for Peace
Charlotte Jewish Voice for Peace
District 4 Action for Gaza
Eisenhower Chapter 157 Veterans for Peace
Muslim Caucus of the NC Democratic Party
Muslims for Social Justice
National Iranian American Council (NIAC) Action - North Carolina
NC Coalition for Gaza
NC Council of Churches
People's Power Lab

Chapel Hill Monthly Meeting of the Religious Society of Friends
531 Raleigh Road, Chapel Hill, NC 27514
Resident: John Hite (919) 929-5377